

Matthew 8; Mark 2–4; Luke 7

Feb 27-Mar 5

Heals a Paralytic

Lowered through the Roof

39 And he preached in their synagogues throughout all Galilee, and cast out ^adevils.

40 And there came a ^aleper to him, beseeching him, and kneeling down to him, and saying unto him, If thou wilt, thou canst make me ^bclean.

41 And Jesus, moved with ^acompassion, put forth *his* hand, and touched him, and saith unto him, I will; be thou clean.

42 And as soon as he had spoken, immediately the leprosy departed from him, and he was cleansed.

43 And he ^astraitly charged him, and forthwith sent him away;

44 And saith unto him, See thou say nothing to any man: but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer for thy cleansing those things which Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

45 But he went out, and began to publish *it* much, and to ^ablaze abroad the matter, insomuch that Jesus could no more openly enter into the city, but was without in desert places: and they came to him from every quarter.

CHAPTER 2

Jesus forgives sins, heals a paralytic, eats with tax gatherers and sinners, and announces that He is Lord of the Sabbath.

AND again he entered into Capernaum after *some* days; and it was noised that he was ^ain the house.

2 And straightway many were gathered together, insomuch that there was no room to receive *them*, no, not so much as about the door: and he ^apreached the word unto them.

3 And they come unto him, bringing one sick of the palsy, which was ^aborne of four.

Jesus Heals a Paralytic

4 And when they could not come nigh unto him for the press, they uncovered the roof where he was: and when they had broken *it* up, they let down the bed wherein the sick of the palsy lay.

5 When Jesus saw their faith, he said unto the sick of the palsy, Son, *thy sins be ^aforgiven thee.*

6 But there were certain of the scribes sitting there, and reasoning in their hearts,

7 Why doth this *man* thus speak ^ablasphemies? who can forgive sins but God only?

8 And immediately when Jesus perceived in his spirit that they so reasoned within themselves, he said unto them, Why reason ye these things in your hearts?

9 Whether is it easier to say to the sick of the palsy, *Thy sins be forgiven thee*; or to say, Arise, and take up thy bed, and walk?

10 But that ye may know that the ^aSon of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (he saith to the sick of the palsy,)

11 I say unto thee, ^aArise, and take up thy ^bbed, and go thy way into thine house.

12 And immediately he arose, took up the bed, and went forth before them all; insomuch that they were all amazed, and glorified God, saying, We never saw it on this fashion.

13 And he went forth again by the sea side; and all the multitude resorted unto him, and he taught them.

14 And as he passed by, he saw Levi the *son* of Alphæus sitting at the ^areceipt of custom, and said unto him, Follow me. And he arose and followed him.

15 And it came to pass, that, as Jesus sat at meat in his house, many publicans and sinners sat also together with Jesus and his disciples:

Jesus Calls Levi

^aits, Evil or n.

^b GR pure.
41a TG Compassion.

Elder James W. McConkie III (October 2022 General Conference)

“...several important truths become clear about Jesus as the Christ.

1. First, when we try to help someone we love come unto Christ, we can do so with ***confidence that He has the capacity*** to lift the burden of sin and to forgive.
2. Second, when we bring physical, emotional, or other illnesses to Christ, we can do so ***knowing He has the power*** to heal and comfort.
3. Third, when we make effort like the four to bring others to Christ, we can do so with ***certainty that He sees our true intentions*** and will appropriately honor them.

Remember, Jesus’s teaching was disrupted by the appearance of a hole in the roof. Rather than chastise or dismiss the four who made the hole for interrupting, the scripture tells us that “Jesus saw their faith.” Those who witnessed the miracle then “marvelled, and glorified God, which had given such power [to] men.”

Cleanse the Leper

Wrapped in bandages

Jesus Cleanses a Leper

CHAPTER 8

Jesus heals a leper, cures the centurion's servant and others, stills the tempest, and casts out devils—The devils enter a herd of swine.

WHEN he was come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him.

2 And, behold, there came a ^aleper and worshipped him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.

3 And Jesus put forth *his* hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was ^acleansed.

4 And Jesus saith unto him, See thou tell no man; but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

5 ¶ And when Jesus was entered into Capernaum, there came unto him a centurion, beseeching him

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Cleanse the Leper

- Matthew 5, 6, and 7 is the Sermon on the Mount
 - Amazing sermon teaching the doctrines of his gospel
 - The Law of the Gospel, this higher upgrade to the laws given to Moses in the Old Testament
 - So he's taught them, and now he's going to use miracles as an object lesson to show them.
 - He doesn't just tell them what to do, he shows them what it looks like in practice.
- ch8v1 -
 - What you're going to find in chapter 8 is that many of the people that he's interacting with are people that would have been considered very unclean, very unfit, not ritually cleansed to be a part of normal society in Jewish 1st century context.
 - He came down from the mountain, great multitudes followed.
- v2, 3, and 4
 - The leper came and worshipped him.
 - Remember, this great multitude that is following him would be revolted by having a leper among them, because they would be saying
 - you're unclean.
 - you don't belong with us.

- You'll notice there's no sense of rejection of real from Jesus.
 - He doesn't shy away, but he put forth his hand and he touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean.
 - Jesus specializes in touching that which is considered unclean by everybody else in society.
- It's one thing to read this story from the safety of the crowd, of the multitude, of picturing myself being there and kind of upset at this guy for coming in and scared when Jesus reaches forth his hand to touch this leper.
- That's the safe zone, the the real place that I find great power in this miracle is not from the safety of the crowd, but on the ground in front of Jesus embodied in the leper, because this is really my story.
 - I'm the one who's unclean.
 - I'm the one who has fallen short.
 - I'm the one who doesn't belong in heaven or in clean company.
 - I'm the one who's coming to the Lord and who desperately needs the Saviour Jesus Christ and his love and his mercy and his power and his miracles to cleans me.
- I love it when the scriptures become a mirror, not a lens alone to see other people, but to see myself and say, Lord I need thee, and to come to him worshipping saying
 - If thou wilt, thou canst make me clean
- All of a sudden it goes way beyond a physical cleansing of a leper to a spiritual miracle, the miracle of forgiveness,

Cures Paralysis

Centurion's servant

the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that ^ahouse; and it ^bfell: and great was the fall of it.

28 And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended ^athese sayings, the people were ^bastonished at his ^cdoctrine:

29 For he taught them as *one* having ^aauthority, and not as ^bthe scribes.

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5 ¶ And when Jesus was entered into Capernaum, there came unto him a centurion, beseeching him,

6 And saying, Lord, my ^aservant lieth at home sick of the ^bpalsy, grievously tormented.

7 And Jesus saith unto him, I will come and heal him.

8 The centurion answered and said,

Lord, I am not ^aworthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my servant shall be ^bhealed.

9 For I am a man under ^aauthority, having soldiers under me: and I say to this *man*, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth *it*.

10 ^aWhen Jesus heard *it*, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great ^bfaith, no, not in Israel.

11 And I say unto you, That ^amany shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven.

12 But the ^achildren of the kingdom shall be cast out into ^bouter darkness: there shall be ^cweeping and ^dgnashing of teeth.

13 And Jesus said unto the centurion, Go thy way; and as thou hast believed, so be it done unto thee. And his servant was healed in the selfsame hour.

14 ¶ And when Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his ^awife's mother ^blaid, and sick of a fever.

15 And he ^atouched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.

16 ¶ When the even was come, they brought unto him many that were possessed with ^adevils: and he cast out the ^bspirits with *his* word, and ^chealed all that were sick:

The Faith of a Centurion

Jesus Heals Many

earth; against which the stream did beat vehemently, and immediately it fell; and the ruin of that house was great.

CHAPTER 7

Jesus heals the centurion's servant—Jesus raises from death the son of the widow of Nain—He praises John the Baptist as more than a prophet—A woman anoints Jesus' feet, and He forgives her sins.

Now when he had ended all his sayings in the audience of the people, he entered into Capernaum.

2 And a certain centurion's servant, who was dear unto him, was sick, and ready to die.

3 And when he heard of Jesus, he sent unto him the elders of the Jews, beseeching him that he would come and heal his servant.

4 And when they came to Jesus, they besought him ^ainstantly, saying, That he was worthy for whom he should do this:

5 For he loveth our nation, and he hath built us a synagogue.

6 Then Jesus went with them. And when he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying unto him, Lord, trouble not thyself: for I am not worthy that thou shouldest enter under my roof:

7 Wherefore neither thought I myself worthy to come unto thee: but say in a word, and my servant shall be healed.

8 For I also am a man set under authority, having under me soldiers, and I say unto one, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth *it*.

9 When Jesus heard these things, he marvelled at him, and turned him about, and said unto the people that followed him, I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in ^aIsrael.

10 And they that were sent, returning to the house, found the servant whole that had been sick.

11 ¶ And it came to pass the day after, that he went into a city called Nain; and many of his disciples went with him, and much people.

12 Now when he came nigh to the gate of the city, behold, there was a dead man carried out, the only son of his mother, and she was a widow: and much people of the city was with her.

13 And when the Lord saw her, he had ^acompassion on her, and said unto her, Weep not.

14 And he came and touched the bier: and they that bare *him* stood still. And he said, Young man, I say unto thee, Arise.

15 And he that was ^adead sat up, and began to speak. And he delivered him to his mother.

16 And there came a ^afear on all: and they glorified God, saying, That a great prophet is risen up among us; and, That God hath ^bvisited his people.

17 And this rumour of him went forth throughout all Judæa, and throughout all the region round about.

18 And the disciples of ^aJohn shewed him of all these things.

19 ¶ And John calling *unto him* two of his disciples sent *them* to Jesus, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?

20 When the men were come unto him, they said, John Baptist hath sent us unto thee, saying, Art thou he that should come? or look we for another?

21 And in that same hour he ^acured many of *their* infirmities and plagues, and of evil spirits; and unto many *that were* blind he gave ^bsight.

22 Then Jesus answering said unto them, Go your way, and tell John what things ye have seen and heard; how that the blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the

Cures Paralysis - Centurion's servant

- This isn't just a typical centurion in the Roman army stationed in Capernaum.
 - This is a guy who has been very kind to the Jewish people.
 - Luke 7, He's been a benefactor and they say he financed the building of a synagogue.
 - Math 8, He's a man of authority - leading soldiers.
 - He gets whatever he asks for. People do his bidding.
- So the leaders of the Jews in that location have come to Jesus requesting this miracle in behalf of the centurion's servant who is sick of the palsy - paralyzed - they're pleading with Jesus for a physical miracle.
- Matt 8:5 -
 - Once again, if you're in the crowd, the typical Jewish response in the 1st century is, you don't interact with gentiles. They're considered ritually unclean.
 - You don't even talk to them unless you absolutely have to
 - You don't walk with them unless you absolutely have to
 - You don't eat with them, you don't have them come into your home.
 - You don't associate with them
 - What a contrast to now see Jesus showing us the way.
 - Not putting up walls between you and people, but building bridges
 - Not trying to prevent them from getting in, but you going out and blessing them

- v10 - I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.
- If you put this into its historical context, in its setting of the time, we assume that Matthew is writing his gospel years after Jesus' ascension into heaven.
 - Many years later ~ you know, ten, fifteen, twenty years later
- Whenever it is that Matthew is writing this, we know that there are some struggles in the early Christian congregations with some clashes, some disputations between our Jewish Christian converts and our gentile Christian converts coming into the fold and seeing things a little differently.
- Matthew - speaking largely to a Jewish audience, is sharing this story because he emphasizes something.
- Notice where Jesus had said I can't find this kind of faith that this gentile centurion is expressing and displaying in all of the house of Israel, I can't find it.
- As if Matthew is saying to his Jewish Christian audience:
 - Don't become prideful.
 - Don't think that you're better than those gentile Christian converts that are coming into the church.
- v11&12 - many shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven.
- These would have been very jarring, would have been very shocking to the cultural sensitive ears of a 1st century Jewish audience, but Matthew is trying to teach a principle from the Lord here,
 - that the gospel and this covenant promise was never intended to be exclusively for just one small group of people in the Middle East.
 - It was intended to be given to them to then spread to the whole world, realizing that when you go into the world you're going to run into people who already have incredible amounts of faith in God.
 - They've already been prepared to receive the fullness of this covenant and this gospel of Jesus Christ
- v13 - I know your tradition as Jews - speak and it will be done

Raising the Dead

Widow of Nain

whole that had been sick.

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Jesus Raises a Widow's Son

Raising the Dead

- Luke 7:13 - Widow of Nain - Weep not
 - Does Jesus ever say things to me that in the context I'm like, that doesn't make any sense at all.
 - Are you unaware of what I'm dealing with and you're telling me to be of good cheer?
 - And yet we know how the story ends in this miracle.
 - So when I read this story I think, okay, in my own life, am I choosing to trust that when God tells me to be of good cheer and weep not, that he has a larger plan and he sees how things will end and that it will be a joyful end.
- v14 - And he said, Young man, I say unto thee, Arise.
 - I think Jesus says the same thing to all of us.
 - That's his invitation to all of us. If you can, once again, not just see this story from one perspective, don't just put yourself in the place of those disciples following Jesus into Nain and kind of being an innocent bystander watching this miracle take place.
 - Insert yourself symbolically into the story.
 - For some of you you're going to find it very easy to insert yourself into the place of the widow feeling like things are happening out of your control and you don't know what you're going to do moving forward.
 - For others of you, you're going to find yourself being represented by those who are carrying the guy.
 - For other, you're the man who's lying there feeling dead, you've lost something, it's gone and it's only one person who can fix that, it's only one, and he comes and he touches the beir, stops it and then tells the man, "Arise"
 - Just like he tells you and me, Arise.
- I think this widow woman, if she were standing here today, would be able to speak with authenticity in saying,
 - hold on to hope, hold on to faith,
 - the Savior is able to do things nobody else can do
 - and when he chooses to do that, that's up to him.
 - How he chooses to do that, that's up to him, but the Good Shepherd will find ways to reach out and say "Arise"
 - And then be able to restore those relationships

Heals the Sick

Peter's Mother-in-law
In bed with a Fever

selfsame hour.

14 ¶ And when Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his ^awife's mother ^blaid, and sick of a fever.

15 And he ^aouched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.

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Jesus Heals Many

Heals the Sick - Peter's Mother-in-law

- Matthew 8:14-15 - Peter's Mother-in-law
 - I love that conclusion, that in being healed, she didn't waste any time and then returning some of that God given grace and reflecting it backward and ministering to people,
 - It would be easy to just read those two verses and say,
 - oh how neat, Jesus healed Peter's mother-in-law, how kind, how wonderful.
 - But if you dig down into that story and have that scripture page become a mirror, you can say,
 - Oh, wait a minute, that's me.
 - In a symbolic sense that I've received healing where Jesus touched me and took away a fever, took away an infirmity of some sort, either spiritual or physical or mental or emotional or financial or relational, whatever it may be, and now it's not my job just to sit there an gloat in the fact that I got this miracle, but now I've been given strength, I've been given new energy, what should I do with that?
 - I should arise from that sickbed, whatever form it took in your life, and look for ways to now minister, to now help other people feel the touch of the Savior's all-powerful love and that the hand of power through our kind acts and our ministering efforts, whatever that might look like in your world.

Calming the Seas

On a small boat in a tempest

Matthew 8

Jesus Calms a Storm

The Cost of Following Jesus

saying, "Himself took our ^binfirmities, and bare *our* ^csicknesses.

18 ¶ Now when Jesus saw great multitudes about him, he gave commandment to depart unto the other side.

19 And a certain scribe came, and said unto him, Master, I will ^afollow thee whithersoever thou goest.

20 And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air *have* nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay *his* head.

21 And another of his disciples said unto him, Lord, ^asuffer me first to go and bury my father.

22 But Jesus said unto him, ^aFol-
low me; and let the ^bdead bury their dead.

23 ¶ And when he was entered into a ship, his disciples followed him.

24 And, behold, there arose a great ^atempest in the sea, inasmuch that the ship was covered with the waves: but he was asleep.

25 And his disciples came to *him*, and awoke him, saying, Lord, save us: we perish.

26 And he saith unto them, Why are ye ^afearful, O ye of little faith? Then he arose, and ^brebuked the winds and the sea; and there was a great calm.

27 But the men marvelled, saying, What manner of man is this, that even the winds and the ^asea obey him!

28 ¶ And when he was come to the other side into the country of the Gergesenes, there met him two possessed with ^adevils, wearing out

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Jesus Calms a Storm

The Parable of the Mustard

33 And with many such parables spake he the word unto them, as they were ^aable to hear *it*.

34 But without a parable spake he not unto them: and when they were alone, he expounded all things to his disciples.

35 And the same day, when the even was come, he saith unto them, Let us pass over unto the other side.

36 And when they had sent away the multitude, they took him even as he was in the ship. And there were also with him other little ships.

37 And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that it was now full.

38 And he was in the hinder part of the ship, asleep on a pillow: and they awake him, and say unto him, Master, carest thou not that we perish?

39 And he arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, ^aPeace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great ^bcalm.

40 And he said unto them, Why are ye so ^afearful? how is it that ye have no ^bfaith?

41 And they feared exceedingly, and said one to another, What manner of man is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?

CHAPTER 5

Jesus casts out a legion of devils, who then enter the swine—A woman is healed by touching Jesus' clothes. He

Mark 4

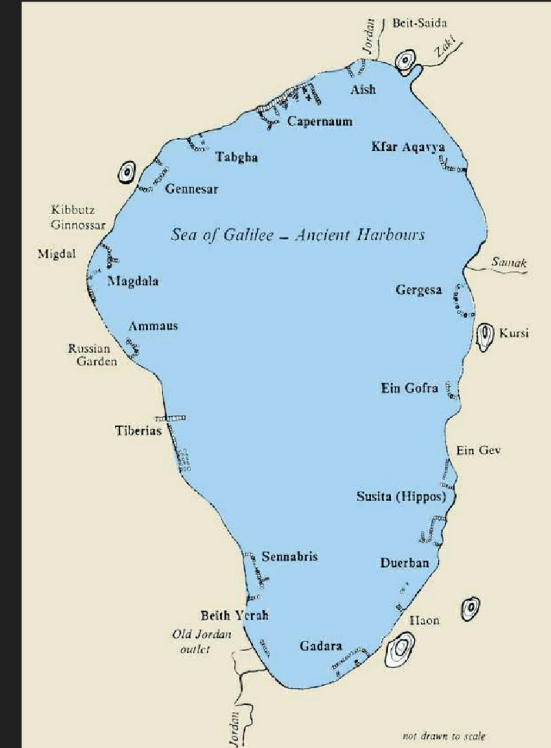
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Calming the Seas

- Mark 4:35 - There going to be tested this night...
- Isn't it fascinating that the testing comes because we're headed in a new direction?
 - We're taking the gospel somewhere where its never been.
 - We're doing something that hasn't been done before.
 - Whenever you endeavor to go and engage in something new,
 - You cross over to that other side and as you go, opposition often mounts up to thwart you and to make you give up and to not move forward.
 - I love the fact that you're going to watch how Jesus responds to this opposition as opposed to how his disciples respond.
- v36-37 -
 - The wind is so violent that the boat is now full with water.
 - The waves have come in and you can picture this thing just kind of limping along.
 - It's dark. I might be disoriented, I don't even know which direction to paddle, I'm probably worrying about bailing at this point and it's not doing any good because the wind and the waves keep replacing the water inside the boat and I'm feeling completely overwhelmed, scared to death.
- v38 - what is Jesus' response?
 - Jesus, do you not even care that we're all going to drown tonight?
- v39 - he rebukes the wind "and there was a great calm"
 - He didn't just calm the winds on the sea, he also calmed the storm and the winds and the waves inside of the souls of those disciples too.
- v41 - "What manner of man is this that even the wind and the sea obey him?"



Casting out Devils

Casting out Devils

- Here's he's casting out devils, there's nothing more unclean than a devil and a spirit of the devil inside of a person.
- Once again, Jesus is interacting with that which is unclean and leaving those people whole - cleaned, purified in that moment.
- This is our story. To one degree or another, we are embodied symbolically in all of these stories and we desperately need the Lord to be the one to clean us, to cleanse us, to heal us.
 - Jesus is really a man of sorrows and acquainted with grief.
 - He has borne our griefs and carried our sorrows.
 - He knows what you're going through.
 - In fact, he's the only one who perfectly knows exactly what you are going through, because he's experienced it for himself all alone through his infinite atonement.

President Russell M. Nelson

- God is a God of miracles.
- Seek and expect miracles.
 - The Power of Spiritual Momentum
 - By President Russell M. Nelson
- Each of these miracles took time and may not have been exactly what those individuals originally requested from the Lord.
- In the same way, the Lord will bless you with miracles if you believe in Him, “doubting nothing.”
- Do the spiritual work to seek miracles.
- Prayerfully ask God to help you exercise that kind of faith.
- I promise that you can experience for yourself that Jesus Christ “giveth power to the faint; and to them that have no might he increaseth strength.”